RANK 2025	STATE
1	KERALA
2	TAMIL NADU
3	WEST BENGAL
4	MAHARASHTRA
5	ODISHA
6	HIMACHAL PRADESH
7	HARYANA
8	UTTARAKHAND
9	CHANDIGARH
10	NCT OF DELHI
11	TELANGANA
12	BIHAR
13	JHARKHAND
14	RAJASTHAN
15	CHHATTISGARH
16	ASSAM
17	ANDHRA PRADESH
18	KARNATAKA
19	MADHYA PRADESH
20	GUJARAT
21	PUNJAB
22	UTTAR PRADESH

right. For instance, a day after a paan masala-spitting incident in the Uttar Pradesh assembly, the Speaker banned gutka and paan masala on the premises, with a Rs 1,000 fine for violators.

Ironically, as sociologist Dipankar Gupta observes, the survey overturns the long-held assumption that India's civic shortcomings stem from ignorance, necessitating widespread education on proper public behaviour. Instead, the findings reveal that most people already understand what is right, but routinely fail to act accordingly. The survey reveals that 85 per cent of the respondents disapprove of evading transport fares. Yet, Indian Railways alone detected 36 million cases of ticketless travel in 2023-24, resulting in Rs 2,231.74 crore in fines.

The stark contrast between expressed belief—such as disapproval of littering, ticketless travel or gender inequality—and real-world action underscores a systemic failure of enforcement rather than awareness. The real challenge, therefore, is not teaching ethics but ensuring accountability, compelling individuals to practice what they profess to believe. There are enough global examples of such enforcement. Scoff at Communist China all you will, but in the 1980s, it mobilised elementary schoolchildren to shame adults who spat in public spaces. In New York City, spitting on public transport was outlawed in 1986, with violators facing the possibility of arrest.

The survey uncovers other concerning patterns: an alarming willingness to pay bribes to get things done, for one. Consider Denmark, Finland, Singapore and New Zealand—the world's least corrupt nations, according to Transparency International. Though their combined population is roughly the size of India's Punjab, they rank among the top 25 countries in per capita income, with Singapore and Denmark securing spots in the top 10. This isn't coincidental to their economic success—transparent systems reduce transaction costs, encourage investment and ensure resources reach their intended destinations.

The digital payment revolution offers a glimpse of how civic behaviour can rapidly evolve. Seventy-six per cent of the respondents now prefer digital payments over cash, with Delhi leading at 96 per cent. This civic embrace of transparency in financial transactions parallels the experience of Sweden, where cash transactions represented just 1 per cent of the country's GDP in 2023. The Swedish embrace of digital payments hasn't merely modernised commerce, it has reduced tax evasion, minimised corruption and created a financial system where transparency is the default setting.

Perhaps nowhere is the development-behaviour correlation more evident than in gender attitudes. The World Economic Forum has consistently found that countries with the higher gender parity—like Sweden and Canada—tend to have higher per capita incomes and stronger social welfare indicators. The survey reveals contradictions that help explain India's struggle to fully harness its female workforce. While 93 per cent of the respondents believe daughters deserve the same educational opportunities as sons and 84 per cent support women taking jobs outside the home, these progressive attitudes coexist with patriarchal undercurrents. Sixty-nine per cent still believe male family members should have the final say in major household decisions. While 83 per cent of the respondents reject the idea that a husband is justified in beating his wife, as many as 14 per cent of women believe otherwise—a testament to the internalisation of patriarchal norms.

THE BEHAVIOURAL REVOLUTION INDIA NEEDS IS ALREADY ENVISIONED IN ITS CONSTITUTION. ALL WE NEED TO DO IS TO PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

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